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**MASABA GUPTA | 35 |**
*Entrepreneur*

## "People say *kaali* as a way to put you down"

It happened to me, where somebody coming for my prenatal [massage] said that you must eat a rasgulla every day, because your kid has to turn out lighter than you. Certain things are not politically correct to say but they will still be spoken of.... You will be shocked at how many educated, wealthy, well read and well educated people also feel this way.

The number of times people think calling someone *kaali* (dark) is a way of putting them down, I find that just so absurd. And I am witness to it till today.

*(in an interview to Faye D'Souza on YouTube)*

**KANI KUSRUTI | 39 |**
*Actress*

## "There is a hierarchy of colour, and of beauty"

It is understood by everyone even today, but especially women and girls, that there is a hierarchy of colour, and therefore of beauty. So deeply is this colourism embedded in our consciousness that upon entering any room, an automatic appraisal kicks in: Am I the darkest person in this room? Am I the fairest? Or am I somewhere in the middle?

There is an acknowledgement today of colourism in our society, and I do come across people who say that darker skin tones are beautiful. But is this mere political correctness or do they truly appreciate beauty in all its diversity?

*(excerpts from a column in* The Indian Express*)*